

Flyovers and congestion

What has been shown about journey time, air pollution and noise?

THE CLAIM

“reduce delays, emissions, and noise pollution”

Infrastructure Malta, Msida Creek statement, 28 October 2024

Marsa complete 2021 · Msida flyover open since 18 Dec 2025; wider works continue to 2027

Marsa's figures are agency-reported, without surveys. The one public air monitor at Msida shows no improvement.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

*Plausible benefits;
not shown in the data.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

79%

Marsa travel-time reduction

Reported by Infrastructure Malta in 2021; the underlying surveys are not published.

+14%

NO₂ at the Msida monitor

Jan–Sep 2026 mean 25.2 µg/m³ vs 22.0 in 2025 (2026 data unvalidated). Background stations: about +4%.

1 site

What the Msida data can say

One monitor, about 410 m from the flyover, moved in Jan 2024; works continue. Not proof of harm.

1.4 km

Nearest monitor to Marsa

No EEA-reported air station has operated near the junction since Kordin closed in 2016.

No series

Local noise results

No comparable before-and-after noise measurements were located for either junction.

FAIR TO SAY

Flyovers can cut stops for some movements, and nine months is early; Msida's works are unfinished and 2026 data are unvalidated. But the reductions claimed have not been shown in public data.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ Publish the Marsa survey files and methods.
- ☐ Separate emissions estimates from ambient air-monitor readings.
- ☐ Explain the 2024 move of the Msida sampling point.
- ☐ Measure traffic, air and noise once Msida's layout is complete.